

Department-Specific Exceptions

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Department	Company-wide
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Owner	HR Manager with department heads
Supersedes	DOC-20 v1.1

1. Purpose

Company-wide policies set one rule for everyone. Some departments cannot work under that rule without harming customers or breaking a legal obligation. This document is the single register of those approved exceptions. An exception that is not listed here does not exist, even if a manager has allowed it informally.

2. Precedence Rules [MANDATORY]

- A listed exception replaces the company-wide rule it names, but only for the employees, situations and period stated in the exception.
- Everything that an exception does not mention stays governed by the company-wide policy.
- An exception can never relax a legal requirement, a security control on customer data, or the approval limits for money.
- If two exceptions appear to overlap, the narrower one applies; if still unclear, the HR Manager decides and updates this register within 10 business days.

3. Customer Support – Extended Service Hours [EXCEPTION]

- **Base rule:** standard working hours 08:30–17:30, Monday to Friday (DOC-01 §3.1).
- **Exception:** Customer Support Executives work rotating shifts covering 08:00–20:00 on weekdays and 08:00–12:00 on Saturdays. Each shift is 8 hours including a 1-hour break.
- **Scope:** Customer Support teams at both offices.
- **Conditions:** the 2-business-hour acknowledgement target of DOC-07 §4.1 is measured within the hours of the shift that receives the issue. Saturday shifts are compensated by a weekday off in the same or the following week.
- **Approved by:** Branch Managers. **Valid until:** 31 December 2027, then reviewed.

4. Engineering & Support – On-Call Rotation [EXCEPTION]

- **Base rule:** work is performed during standard working hours (DOC-01 §3.1).
- **Exception:** Software Support Engineers and Team Leaders take part in a weekly on-call rotation outside working hours for incidents that affect all customers. On-call engineers must respond to a page within 15 minutes.
- **Scope:** Engineering teams that run customer-facing systems.
- **Conditions:** on-call staff may work from home during their on-call week using the company VPN and an approved encrypted device (DOC-06 §6); production data access still uses approved, logged tooling only (DOC-06 §4). Each on-call week earns one additional day off.
- **Approved by:** Head of Engineering. **Valid until:** no end date; reviewed yearly.

5. Finance – Month-End Leave Blackout [EXCEPTION]

- **Base rule:** leave is requested through the portal and approved by the direct manager within 2 business days (DOC-03 §6).
- **Exception:** Finance Associates may not take planned annual leave during the last 3 business days of each month, when the month-end close is performed (DOC-15 §4.4).
- **Scope:** Finance team members involved in the close.
- **Conditions:** sick leave and statutory leave are never blocked by this exception (DOC-03 §3, §4). Leave already approved before this register was published is honoured.
- **Approved by:** Finance Manager. **Valid until:** no end date.

6. Sales – Client Entertainment Pre-Approval [EXCEPTION]

- **Base rule:** expenses are claimed after the fact and approved according to the amount (DOC-09 §4).
- **Exception:** Sales Executives may spend up to 3,000,000 VND per client meeting on meals with a prospect or customer without asking for approval in advance.
- **Scope:** Sales Executives with an active opportunity in the CRM for that client.
- **Conditions:** the claim still goes through DOC-09 within 15 calendar days, with the CRM opportunity ID; the 5,000,000 VND Branch Manager threshold of DOC-09 §4 still applies to the monthly total per employee.
- **Approved by:** Head of Sales & Marketing. **Valid until:** 31 December 2027.

7. Data – Access to Identifiable Data for Fraud Review [EXCEPTION]

- **Base rule:** Data Analysts work on anonymised or aggregated datasets by default (DOC-05 §4, DOC-06 §4).
- **Exception:** a named Data Analyst may access identifiable payment records to investigate suspected reimbursement fraud or duplicate payments.
- **Scope:** one Data Analyst per investigation, named in writing.
- **Conditions:** written approval from the Data Privacy Officer before access; access is limited to 10 business days per investigation, is logged, and the working extract is deleted when the investigation closes. Findings are reported to the Finance Manager only.

- **Approved by:** Data Privacy Officer and Finance Manager jointly. **Valid until:** per investigation.

8. Operations – Field Visit Attire and Hours [EXCEPTION]

- **Base rule:** business-casual dress code and standard working hours (DOC-04 §4.1, DOC-01 §3.1).
- **Exception:** Operations Coordinators on partner-school visits are exempt from the office dress code while on site (DOC-04 §7) and may start or finish outside standard hours to match the school timetable.
- **Scope:** days with a field visit planned on the branch calendar (DOC-12 §6.2).
- **Conditions:** professional behaviour standards still apply (DOC-04 §2). Hours worked beyond 8 on a visit day are recorded and taken back within the same month.
- **Approved by:** Branch Manager. **Valid until:** no end date.

9. Đà Nẵng Office – Purchase Approval [EXCEPTION]

- **Base rule:** the Branch Manager approves purchase orders up to 100,000,000 VND (DOC-12 §3.1).
- **Exception:** until the Đà Nẵng office has a full-time Branch Manager, purchase orders for that office up to 30,000,000 VND are approved by the headquarters Branch Manager remotely, and larger orders go directly to the Chief Operating Officer.
- **Scope:** Đà Nẵng office only.
- **Conditions:** expense-claim thresholds of DOC-09 §4 are unchanged.
- **Approved by:** Chief Operating Officer. **Valid until:** the appointment of a Đà Nẵng Branch Manager.

10. Requesting a New Exception

- The department head submits a request to the HR Manager stating the base rule, the proposed exception, the scope, the reason and the proposed end date.
- HR checks the request against the precedence rules of Section 2; requests that would relax a legal requirement, a customer-data security control or a money approval limit are rejected.
- Approved exceptions are added to this register with a new version number and announced to the affected employees. Learning paths that cite the base rule are regenerated so that employees in scope learn the exception.

11. Review

The HR Manager reviews every exception at least once a year and removes exceptions whose end date has passed. An expired exception stops applying on its end date even if this register has not yet been updated.

12. Revision History

Version	Effective date	Section	Change
v1.2	2027-01-01	§3	Customer Support extended hours renewed until 31 December 2027; the Saturday shift moves to 08:00–12:00 (was 09:00–13:00).
v1.2	2027-01-01	§6	Client entertainment without pre-approval rises to 3,000,000 VND per meeting (was 2,000,000 VND), renewed until 31 December 2027.
v1.1	2026-07-01	§4	On-call engineers respond to a page within 15 minutes (was 30).
v1.1	2026-07-01	§9	Base rule aligned with DOC-12 v2.0 (100,000,000 VND); the Đà Nẵng remote-approval limit rises to 30,000,000 VND (was 20,000,000 VND).

13. Cross-References

- Working hours: DOC-01 §3.1; leave workflow: DOC-03 §6
- Dress code and field visits: DOC-04 §4, §7; DOC-12 §6.2
- Data access: DOC-05 §4; DOC-06 §4, §6
- Escalation acknowledgement: DOC-07 §4.1
- Expense approval: DOC-09 §4; purchase limits: DOC-12 §3.1
- Finance month-end: DOC-15 §4.4